

ALMILA BASAK

CONTACT INFORMATION

Department of Political Science
Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs
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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy — Political Science 2021 – 2027
Syracuse University *(Expected)*

- Fields: Comparative Politics (Major), Law and Courts (Minor)
- Dissertation: *Varieties of Right-Wing Populism in Europe*
- Committee: Seth K Jolly (Chair), Margarita Estevez-Abe, Jessie Trudeau

Master of Arts — Political Science 2021 – 2023
Syracuse University

Bachelor of Science - Political Science and Public Administration 2014 – 2019
Middle East Technical University, Turkey
Minor: Economics

ACADEMIC AFFILIATIONS

Graduate Research Associate 2024 – Present
Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs,
Center for European Studies, Syracuse University

Graduate Research Associate 2023 – Present
Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs,
Middle Eastern Studies Program, Syracuse University

Teaching Associate 2023 – 2026
Future Professoriate Program,
Syracuse University

Research

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Subfields: Political Parties, Populism, Comparative Political Economy, Politics of Social Policy, European Politics, Turkish Politics

WORKING PAPERS

- [3] "Welfare Promises of Populist Right Parties: Whom to Attract and How to Allocate?"
- [2] "The Electoral Returns to Bending Campaign Rules: Evidence from Brazil" (with Dr. Trudeau)
- [1] "Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers? Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence" (with Dr. Jolly)

IN PROGRESS

- [3] "Social Policy Preferences in Populist Welfare Regimes: Evidence from Turkey"
- [2] "Understanding the Gender Gap in Party Preferences: The role of welfare state inclusiveness"

- [1] Measuring Issue Salience for Party Manifestos using LLMs: Alternative to Hand-coding?

RESEARCH	Graduate Research Assistant,	
APPOINTMENTS	<i>Dr. Jessie Trudeau</i>	Spring 2026
	Graduate Research Assistant,	
	<i>Dr. Jessie Trudeau</i>	Spring 2025
	Graduate Research Assistant,	
	<i>Dr. Jessie Trudeau</i>	2023-2024
	Global Free Speech Repository Research Assistant,	
	<i>Dr. Thomas Keck</i>	2022 – 2023
CONFERENCE	[12] "Welfare Promises of Right-Wing Populist Parties:Whom to Attract	
PRESENTATIONS	and How to Allocate?"	April 2026
	presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Conference.	
	[11] "The electoral returns to vote buying: Evidence from Brazil"	April 2026
	presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Conference	
	with Dr. Jessie Trudeau.	
	[10] "The electoral returns to vote buying: Evidence from Brazil"	April 2026
	presented at the Political Science Research Workshop at	
	Syracuse University.	
	[9] "Welfare Promises of Right-Wing Populist Parties:Whom to Attract	
	and How to Allocate?"	March 2026
	presented at the European Politics Workshop at Syracuse University.	
	[8] "Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers?	
	Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence"	May 2025
	presented at the European Union Studies Association Conference	
	with Prof Seth Jolly.	
	[7] "Welfare Platforms of Populist Entrepreneurs"	March 2025
	presented at the Political Science Research Workshop at	
	Syracuse University.	
	[6] "Welfare Platforms of Populist Entrepreneurs"	March 2025
	presented at the European Politics Workshop at	
	Syracuse University.	
	[5] "Welfare State Policies: Window for Party Politics?,"	September 2024
	presented at the American Political Science Association Conference.	
	[4] "Welfare State Policies: Window for Party Politics?,"	April 2024
	presented at the Political Science Research Workshop at	
	Syracuse University.	
	[3] "Understanding the Gender Gap in Party Preferences:	
	The Case of the AKP era in Turkey"	March 2025
	presented at the European Politics Workshop at	
	Syracuse University.	
	[2] "Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP,"	November 2022
	presented at the Northeastern Political Science Association.	
	[1] "Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP,"	September 2022
	presented at the Political Science Research Workshop at	
	Syracuse University.	

SKILLS

Statistics Software: R, R Studio, ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, GitHub, MAXQDA
Document Preparation Systems: L^AT_EX, R Markdown, Microsoft Office Suite

Teaching

TEACHING ASSISTANT	PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics, <i>Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe</i> Role: Section Leader	Fall 2025
	PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics, <i>Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe</i> Role: Section Leader	Fall 2024
INSTRUCTOR OF RECORD	PSC 388 Globalization and the Rise of Populism	May 2024

Grants, Awards, and Honors

GRANTS	Summer Dissertation Fellowship <i>Graduate School, Syracuse University</i>	2026
	Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant <i>Graduate School, Syracuse University</i>	2026
	Research Assistantship Fellowship <i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	Spring 2026
	Roscoe Martin Fund for Dissertation and Thesis Research <i>Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs, Syracuse University</i>	2025
	Goekjian/Center for European Studies Research Grant <i>Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs, Syracuse University</i>	2025
	Research Assistantship Fellowship <i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	Spring 2025
	Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant <i>Graduate Student Organization, Syracuse University</i>	2024
	Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant <i>Graduate Student Organization, Syracuse University</i>	2023
	Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2022-23
	Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2021-22

AWARDS

The Ketcham Award

For students whose work exhibits a commitment to open and just public life
Political Science Department, Syracuse University

2026

Certificate in University Teaching

The Future Professoriate Program, Syracuse University

2026

Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award

Graduate School, Syracuse University

2026

Koff Award

The best graduate student paper written each year on comparative politics
Political Science Department, Syracuse University

2025

Young Scholar Prize

*For the paper "Social Policy and the Gender Gap in Party Preferences:
 The Case of the AKP era in Turkey"*
Middle East Studies Program, Syracuse University

2023

HONORS

Graduated as **first-ranked student** of the Middle East Technical University's
 Political Science Department

June 2019

Graduated as **third-ranked student** of the Middle East Technical University

June 2019

Service**TO THE
INSTITUTION**

Co-President, Political Science Graduate Student Association.

2023-2024

Pre-Comprehensive Exams Student Representative,
 Political Science Graduate Student Association.

2022-2023

Political Science Department Representative,
 Syracuse University Graduate Student Organization,
 Graduate Pandemic Committee member

2021-2022

**TO THE
DISCIPLINE**

Panelist, *Independent Teaching as a Graduate Student*
 organized by Future Professoriate Program

October 2025

Co-organizer, *Future Professoriate Program seminar:*
"How to present at a conference?"

at Political Science Research Workshop, Syracuse University

October 2024

Organizer, *Geocoding Workshop with Dr Trudeau*
 for Political Science Graduate Students.

October 2024

Co-organizer, *Future Professoriate Program seminar:*
"Predocs, Postdocs, and Fellowships: What You Need to Know"
 at Political Science Research Workshop, Syracuse University.

December 2023

**PROFESSIONAL
AFFILIATIONS**

European Political Science Society

2026 – Present

Midwest Political Science Association

2026 – Present

European Union Studies Association

2025 – Present

